

N08 MINDFUL EATING | O (MAX : 2 PT)

Intent : Encourage mindful eating behaviors and communal dining opportunities.

Summary : This WELL feature requires dedicated eating space that contains tables and chairs and the provision of daily meal breaks.

Issue : Our eating behaviors are influenced by a variety of factors that extend beyond just hunger. Additional factors that influence our food choices, include economic, social, psychological and environmental determinants. Recently, eating alone and distracted eating have become emerging social concerns and are associated with a variety of social and health outcomes. Studies have found that people who tend to eat alone may be more likely to choose healthier foods, eat fewer fruits and vegetables and eat at irregular times.¹ Eating alone may also be a potential risk factor for metabolic syndrome, a group of risk factors that increase the risk of heart disease, stroke and diabetes.^{2,3} There is also some evidence to indicate that distracted eating while working, reading, watching television or listening to music is associated with higher food intake both immediately and later on.⁴

Solutions : Eating attentively and placing focus on the process of eating may lead to better control of one's food intake. A positive relationship also exists between mindful eating and mental well-being.⁴ The provision of dedicated eating spaces can encourage individuals to enjoy meals together, prevent distracted eating at workstations and lead to better eating habits. In addition to eating spaces, having designated meal periods can help ensure individuals have and take time to eat meals mindfully.

PART 1 SUPPORT MINDFUL EATING (MAX : 2 PT)

For All Spaces except Dwelling Units:

1: Dedicated eating space

A dedicated eating space is located within a 200 m walk distance of the project boundary and meets the following requirements:

- Contains tables and chairs to accommodate at least 25% of regular occupants at peak occupancy. If multiple dedicated eating spaces are present, the combined seating space must accommodate at least 25% of regular occupants at peak occupancy.
- Provides protection from environmental elements (e.g., direct sunlight, rain, wind) or is in a climate-controlled space.
- Accommodates a variety of seating arrangements, including small group (up to 4 people) and large group (more than 4 people) seating.

2: Daily meal breaks

The following requirement is met:

- Eligible employees and students (as applicable) have a daily meal break of at least 30 minutes.

REFERENCES

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